you've probably been told, and maybe even believe, that explaining a joke

WHY YOU SHOULD THE explain jokes

{A ZINE THAT - IF IT IS FUNNY AT ALL - IS FUNNY BECAUSE OF THE ABSURDITY OF TAKING AN IDEA TOO FAR}

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BUT(T)... I think you should frequently explain the joke!

this is kinda funny, because "but" (used as a coordinating conjunction) is spelled with just ONE "t". Adding the second "t" changes the meaning of the word, even though it doesn't change how you say the word. Butts (the body part are somehow inherently funny... maybe because of societal expectations to act like we don't all fart?

1. for accessibility
2. to consider how various audiences may receive it
3. to learn something new
4. for the bit!

EXPLAINING A JOKE MAKES IT MORE ACCESSIBLE!

- jokes that rely on inside knowledge or refer back to something only some experienced
- language play that requires a high level of language proficiency
- dry humor that neuro-divergent folks might not pick up on at first?

everyone likes to laugh! & leaving someone out on purpose isn't funny.

YOU MIGHT EXPLAIN IT & NO ONE LAUGHS

- ☆ maybe the joke recipients don't have a sense of humor (but consider other explanations first)
- ☆ maybe your explanation of the joke wasn't good enough - keep trying!
- ☆ maybe the joke wasn't actually funny. trying to explain a joke (your own or someone else's) pushes you to think critically about what (or who) you're meant to laugh at

Learning is cool. and I have learned alot over the years by trying to explain a joke or by asking people to explain them to me.

- ☆ "a lot" is 2 words. writing it as one is an oblique reference to a 2000s era online comic. if you didn't hear of it, you could look it up! you might like it

- ☆ I had to look up what part of speech "but" is... now I know!
- ☆ there's a fascinating literature on the history & psychology of humor!

Some of my best laughs have derived from explaining (and then over-explaining) a joke.

So... CONSIDER THAT WHEN YOU EXPLAIN A JOKE, YOU CAN ALSO

DO IT FOR THE BIT